

Peripheral devices

Any piece of hardware that enables users to interact with a computer is called a peripheral device. Without them, there would be no way to unlock a computer's potential.

Peripheral devices

A peripheral is a device that connects to the computer's motherboard. They are generally classified into three categories: input devices, output devices, and storage devices. Some devices, such as a touchscreen or a scanning printer, can be both input and output devices. Peripherals can be developed for all kinds of applications.

▷ Headphones and microphone

Usually connecting to the computer by a 3.5mm (0.14 inch) jack, headphones and microphones allow users to hear audio from and send audio to the computer. Some companies are eliminating physical headphone connections from their devices in favour of Bluetooth connections.

The three sections on the jack send power to the left and right audio, and ground the device.

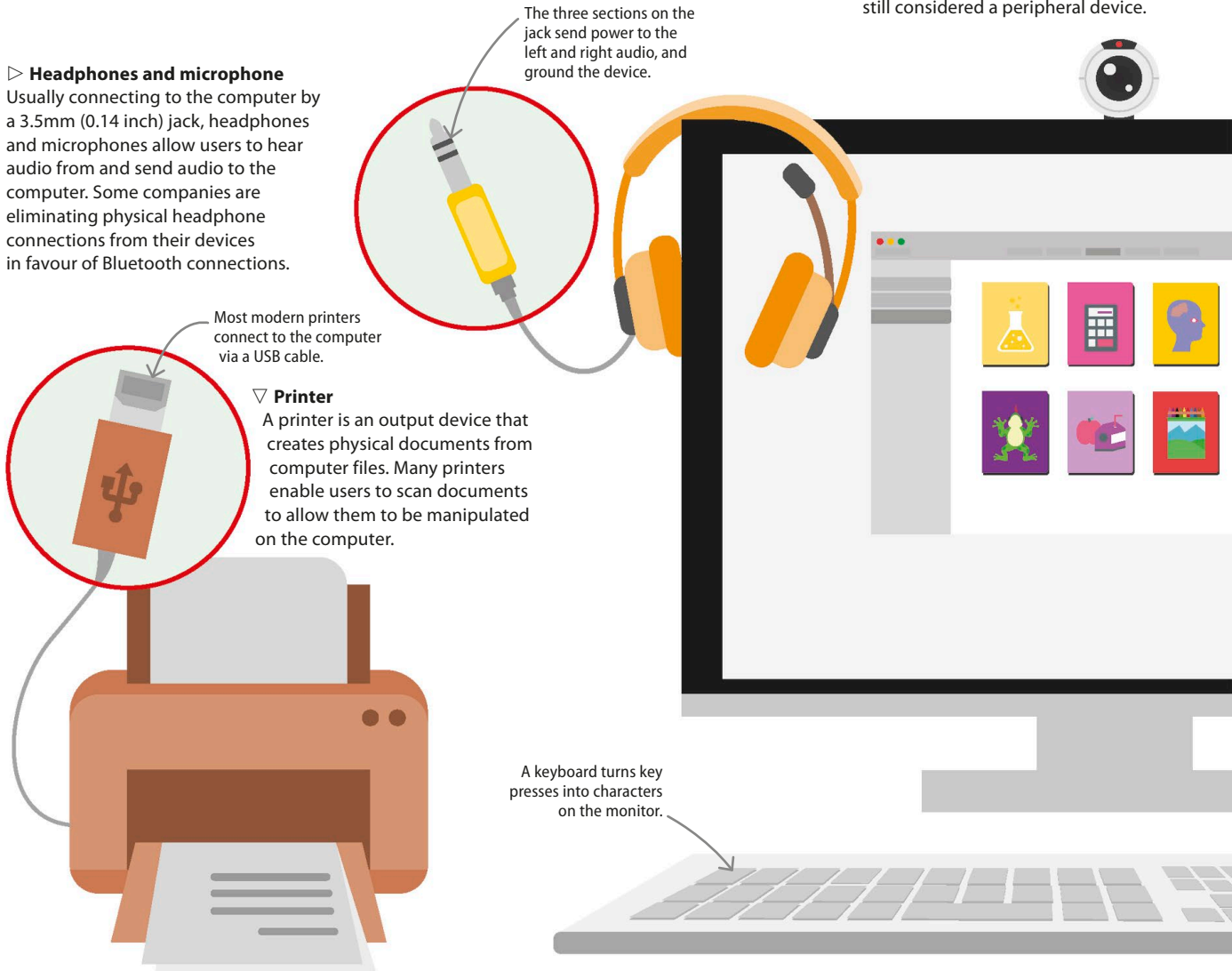
Most modern printers connect to the computer via a USB cable.

▽ Printer

A printer is an output device that creates physical documents from computer files. Many printers enable users to scan documents to allow them to be manipulated on the computer.

Camera ▽

A computer camera, commonly called a "webcam", is an input device that captures video and audio signals. Though most webcams are integrated into the computer's casing, they are still considered a peripheral device.



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